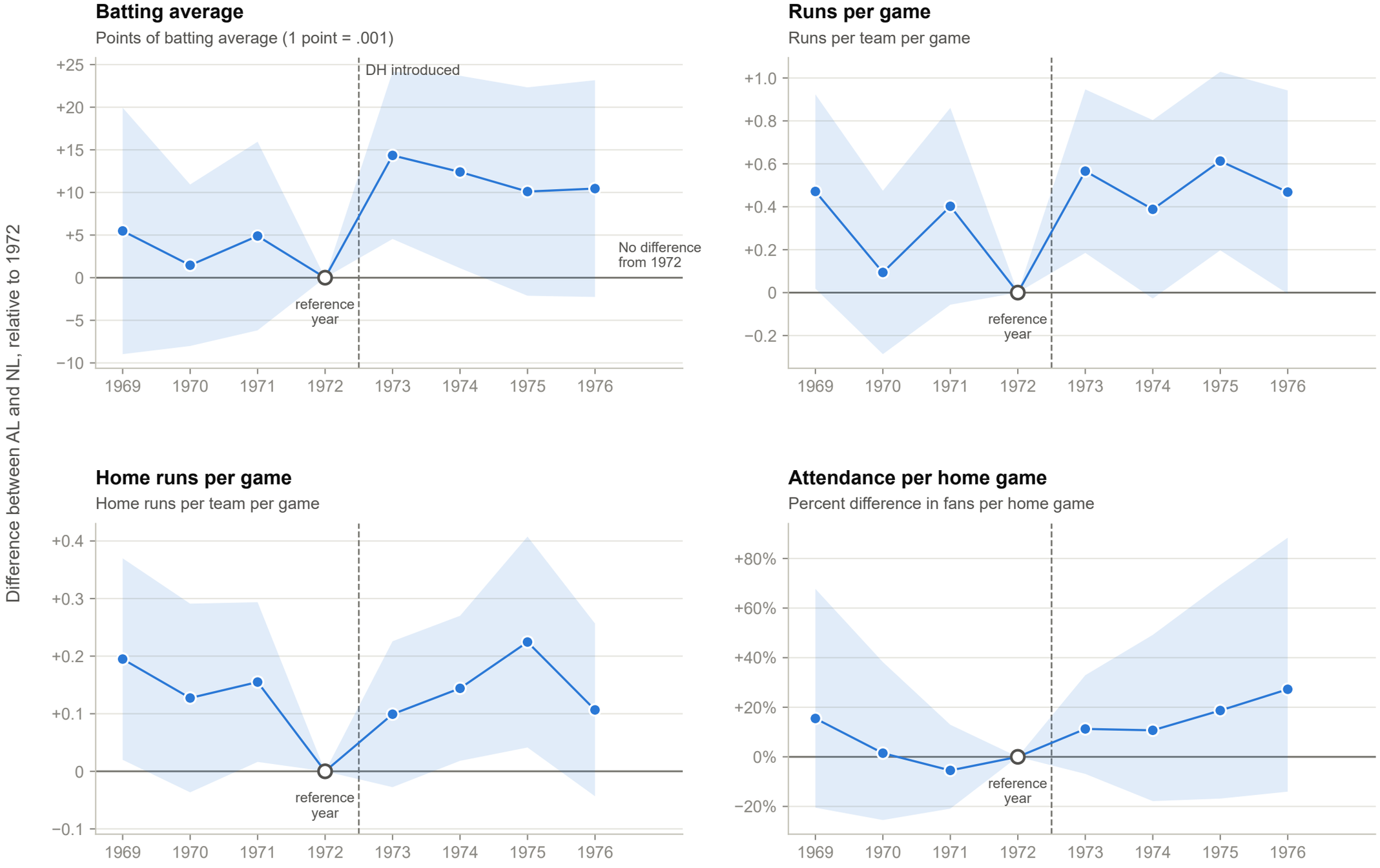
AL batting average jumped in 1973 and stayed above its 1972 level

Each dot is the AL–NL gap in that year minus the gap in 1972; shaded bands show 95% confidence intervals.
Caution: 1972 was an unusually weak year for AL hitters, so most earlier years also sit above zero, especially for runs and home runs.



Source: SABR Lahman Baseball Database (2025). Notes: Estimates from a regression of each measure on AL-by-year indicators with team and year fixed effects, 1969–1976 (192 team-seasons; 1972 omitted). Intervals clustered by franchise (24 clusters). Attendance converted from log points to percent with exp(b) − 1. Only three pre-1973 years are available, so the check for pre-existing differences has limited power; joint test that 1969–71 are all zero: p = 0.77 (batting), 0.09 (runs), 0.11 (home runs), 0.36 (attendance). Batting intervals for 1975–76 include zero.